Topic 16 — Uttarakhand State Current Affairs & Special GK

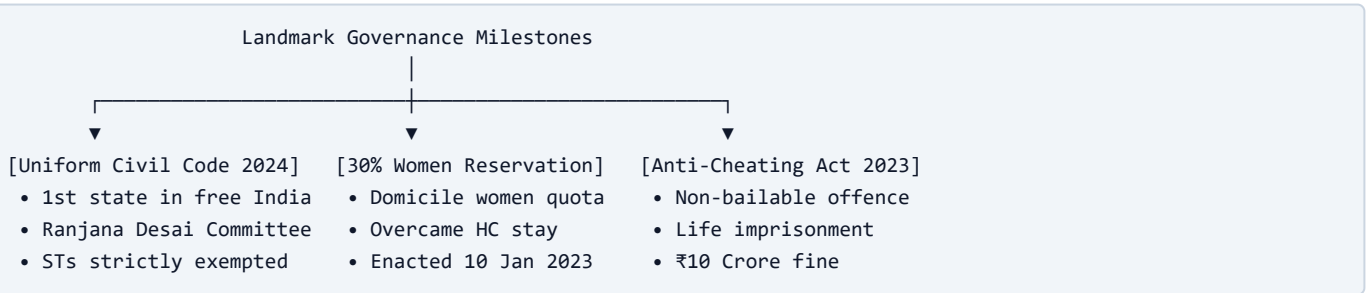
★ UKPCS state card (Unit 6 — Current Events of State, National & International Importance)

> **Sources:** Government of Uttarakhand Portals, DIPR Uttarakhand, PIB Dehradun, GI Registry Chennai, UKPCS PYQ stems (Padma Shri 2025 Radha Bahin Bhatt Q53, Silkyara Tunnel length Q51, UCC 2024 milestones, 30% Women Horizontal Reservation, G20 Ramnagar/Rishikesh venues, 38th National Games, State awards).
> **Desk:** UKPCS Overview · Coverage Report · National Current Affairs

Quick Revision — Spine Only

Head	High-Yield Current Affairs Key
Uniform Civil Code (UCC)	**1st state in independent India**; passed **7 Feb 2024**; assent **11 March 2024**; STs strictly exempted
UCC Committee Head	Retired Supreme Court Judge **Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai**
38th National Games	Hosted by **Uttarakhand** (Dehradun, Haridwar, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Rishikesh)
Women Horizontal Quota	**30% horizontal reservation** for Uttarakhand domicile women in state public services (enacted Jan 2023)
Anti-Cheating Law 2023	India's strictest: **Life imprisonment + ₹10 Crore fine**; 10-year candidate ban
Padma Shri 2025	**Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt** (Social Work — Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani) (UKPCS 2025 Q53)
Padma Shri 2024	**Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch** (Literature & Education — eminent historian of Uttarakhand)
Padma Vibhushan 2022	**General Bipin Rawat** (Posthumous — 1st Chief of Defence Staff, from Saina village, Pauri)
Silkyara Tunnel Length	**4.531 km** (NH-134, Char Dham route, Uttarkashi; 41 miners rescued in Operation Zindagi)
Vibrant Village No. 1	**Mana Village** (Chamoli) officially designated as India's **"First Village"** (not last village)
First Ramsar Site in UK	**Asan Conservation Reserve** (Dehradun, Yamuna-Asan confluence, designated 2020)
Single-Day GI Tag Record	Uttarakhand became the **1st state to receive 18 GI certificates in a single day** (total 27+ GI products)
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail	**125.2 km** BG rail link; **84% (~105 km) in 17 tunnels**; longest tunnel: 15.1 km (Devprayag to Janasu)
Pirul Lao–Paise Pao	Community mission collecting pine needles (*Pirul*) to prevent forest fires; ₹50/kg incentive

1. Landmark Legislation & Governance Current Affairs



1.1 Uniform Civil Code (UCC) of Uttarakhand (2024)

- **Constitutional Basis:** Enacted under **Article 44** (Directive Principles of State Policy).
- **Milestone Dates:** Passed by Vidhan Sabha on **7 February 2024**; received Presidential Assent from President Droupadi Murmu on **11 March 2024**.
- **Drafting Committee:** 5-member committee headed by **Justice (Retd.) Ranjana Prakash Desai** (former Supreme Court Judge). Other members: Shatrughan Singh (ex-Chief Secretary), Prof. Surekha Dangwal (VC Doon University), Manu Gaur, and Pramod Kohli.
- **Key Legal Provisions:**
- **Tribal Exemption:** Explicitly **exempts all Scheduled Tribes (STs)** protected under Article 366(25).

- **Marriage & Polygamy:** Completely prohibits polygamy and bigamy across all religions; minimum age of marriage fixed at **21 for males and 18 for females**.
- **Abolition of Practices:** Bans *Iddat*, *Nikah Halala*, and extra-judicial divorces.
- **Equal Inheritance:** Grants equal property inheritance rights to sons and daughters, eliminating discrimination in ancestral estates.
- **Mandatory Live-In Registration:** Couples residing in live-in relationships must register on the state portal within **1 month** of cohabitation; failure attracts up to 3 months imprisonment; children born from live-in relationships enjoy full legal legitimacy.

1.2 Uttarakhand Public Services (Horizontal Reservation for Women) Act, 2022

- **Enactment:** Passed by Vidhan Sabha and signed by Governor Lt. Gen. Gurmit Singh on **10 January 2023**.
- **Core Provision:** Guarantees **30% horizontal reservation** in direct recruitment to public services and posts under the State Government exclusively for **women domicile residents of Uttarakhand**.
- **Legal Background:** Restored domicile reservation after the Uttarakhand High Court had stayed the previous 2006 government order.

1.3 Uttarakhand Anti-Cheating & Paper Leak Act, 2023

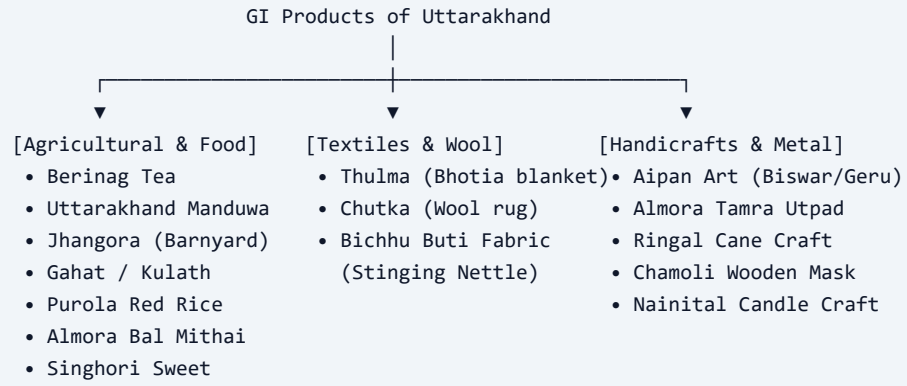
- Enacted as *Uttarakhand Competitive Examination (Measures for Prevention and Redressal of Unfair Means in Recruitment) Act, 2023*.
- **Punishment for Syndicates:** Imprisonment from 10 years to **Life Imprisonment** and a fine of **₹2 Crore to ₹10 Crore**, plus attachment and confiscation of properties acquired through copying syndicates.
- **Punishment for Examinees:** Banned from state recruitment examinations for **10 years** on the first offense, with 3 to 10 years imprisonment.

2. Infrastructure, Transport & Strategic Projects

Project / Infrastructure	Strategic Location & Scale	High-Yield Prelims Data Points
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail Line	125.2 km Broad Gauge across 5 districts	**84% track length (~105 km) lies inside 17 tunnels**. Features the longest rail tunnel in India (**15.1 km** between Devprayag and Janasu). 12 new railway stations. Executed by RVNL.
Silkyara–Barkot Tunnel	NH-134 (Uttarkashi) on Char Dham Highway	**4.531 km length** (cuts Gangotri–Yamunotri route by >20 km). Site of 17-day collapse rescue in Nov 2023 (**Operation Zindagi**). Rescued all 41 workers using rat-hole mining technique.
Sonprayag–Kedarnath Ropeway	Rudraprayag (under Parvatmala Pariyojana)	**9.7 km aerial ropeway**; reduces arduous 8-hour trek to ~30 minutes; terminal at 3,583 m.
Govindghat–Hemkund Sahib Ropeway	Chamoli (under Parvatmala Pariyojana)	**12.4 km aerial ropeway**; connects Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib (4,329 m) and Valley of Flowers.
Jamrani Dam Multipurpose Project	Gola River (Haldwani, Nainital)	Approved under Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY); provides drinking water to Haldwani and irrigation to US Nagar and Bareilly.
Song Dam Drinking Water Project	Song River (Dehradun)	₹2,000+ Cr gravity dam to provide 24x7 drinking water to Dehradun city for 50 years.
Lakhwar Multipurpose Project	Yamuna River (Dehradun) — 300 MW	Gravity dam of 204 m height; benefits 6 basin states (UK, UP, HP, Haryana, Rajasthan, Delhi).
Kishau Multipurpose Project	Tons River (UK–HP border) — 660 MW	Joint project of Uttarakhand and Himachal Pradesh.

3. High-Yield GI Tags of Uttarakhand (Record Haul)

In December 2023, Uttarakhand scripted history by becoming the **first state in India to be awarded 18 GI Certificates in a single day**, taking its total recognized GI portfolio to over 27 products:



GI Product Name	Category & District	Unique Prelims Identifier
Berinag Tea	Agricultural (Pithoragarh)	Wild orthodox black tea from Berinag; historic export to London.
Bichhu Buti (Nettle) Fabric	Textile / Handicraft	Natural organic yarn woven from stinging nettle (*Girardinia diversifolia*).
Uttarakhand Manduwa	Agricultural	Finger millet (*Ragi*); rich in calcium, iron, and dietary fiber.
Jhangora	Agricultural	Barnyard millet; ancient low-glycemic climate-resilient crop.
Gahat (Kulath)	Agricultural	Horse gram; renowned in Ayurvedic medicine for dissolving kidney stones.
Lal Chawal (Red Rice)	Agricultural (Uttarkashi)	Grown organically in the Kamal river valley of Purola.
Almora Bal Mithai	Foodstuff (Almora)	Roasted khoya fudge coated with sugar beads/globules (*Khas-Khas* look).
Singhori	Foodstuff (Tehri / Almora)	Mawa sweet cone-wrapped inside fragrant green *Malu* leaves.
Aipan Folk Art	Handicraft (Kumaon)	Traditional ritual floor/wall art executed on red *Geru* with *Biswar* (rice paste).
Thulma & Chutka	Textile (Pithoragarh/Chamoli)	Dense handwoven pure sheep wool blankets and rugs crafted by Bhotia women.
Ringal Craft	Handicraft (Chamoli)	Baskets, mats, and household craft woven from dwarf bamboo (*Ringal*).
Almora Tamra Utpad	Metalcraft (Almora)	Traditional copperware crafted by the hereditary *Tamta* artisans of Tamta Mohalla.
Munsiari Rajma	Agricultural (Pithoragarh)	Buttery, highly digestible white-and-red kidney beans grown at high altitudes.
Kala Bhatt (Black Soybean)	Agricultural	Rich in protein, anthocyanins; key ingredient for *Bhatt ki Churkani*.

4. International Summits & Defense Exercises in Uttarakhand

4.1 G20 Meetings Hosted in Uttarakhand (2023)

Uttarakhand successfully hosted **three official G20 meetings**: 1. **1st Meeting — Chief Science Advisers' Roundtable (CSAR):** Held at **Ramnagar (Corbett, Nainital)** on 28–30 March 2023. Discussed global disease surveillance and open access to scientific knowledge. 2. **2nd Meeting — Anti-Corruption Working Group (ACWG):** Held at **Narendra Nagar / Rishikesh (Tehri Garhwal)** on 25–27 May 2023. 3. **3rd Meeting — Infrastructure Working Group (IWG):** Held at **Narendra Nagar / Rishikesh** on 26–28 June 2023. Discussed financing future cities and resilient infrastructure.

4.2 Joint Military Exercises Hosted in Uttarakhand

- **Exercise Surya Kiran (India–Nepal):** Annually alternated; conducted regularly at the military training grounds in **Pithoragarh**.
- **Exercise Yudh Abhyas (India–USA):** 18th edition conducted at the high-altitude cold-weather warfare centre in **Auli (Chamoli)** at 9,500 feet.
- **Exercise Dustlik (India–Uzbekistan):** 4th edition held at **Pithoragarh** in February 2023.

5. Sports Current Affairs & Personalities of Uttarakhand

5.1 38th National Games (Hosted by Uttarakhand)

- Uttarakhand was chosen as the proud host of the **38th National Games**.
- **Hub Cities:** Competitions spread across 6 regional venues: **Dehradun, Haridwar, Haldwani, Rudrapur, Rishikesh, and Tehri**.
- **State Mascot: Monal** (State Bird of Uttarakhand).
- Upgraded world-class infrastructure: Maharana Pratap Sports College (Dehradun), Indira Gandhi International Sports Complex (Haldwani).

5.2 Prominent Sports Personalities of Uttarakhand

Athlete Name	Sport & Hometown	Major Achievements & Honors
Lakshya Sen	Badminton (Almora)	Commonwealth Games Gold Medallist, World Championship Bronze, Arjuna Awardee, 4th place at Paris 2024 Olympics.
Chirag Sen	Badminton (Almora)	Senior National Badminton Champion; elder brother of Lakshya Sen.
Ankita Dhyani	Athletics - Distance (Pauri Garhwal)	Represented India at Paris 2024 Olympics in 5000m and 3000m steeplechase.
Mansi Negi	20 km Race Walk (Chamoli)	Gold medallist at World University Games; National Games record holder.
Paramjeet Singh Bisht	20 km Race Walk (Chamoli)	Qualified and represented India at the Paris 2024 Olympics.
Suraj Panwar	20 km Race Walk (Dehradun)	Silver medallist at Youth Olympic Games; Paris 2024 Olympian in marathon race-walk relay.
Sneha Rana	Women's Cricket (Dehradun)	All-rounder for Indian National Women's Cricket Team; historic Test match performances.
Ekta Bisht	Women's Cricket (Almora)	First international cricketer from Uttarakhand; 1st Indian bowler to take a T20I hat-trick.

5.3 Devbhoomi Uttarakhand State Sports Awards

Instituted by the State Government to honor outstanding athletic excellence: - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Khel Ratna:** Highest state sports honor given to an active player. - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Dronacharya Award:** Bestowed upon eminent coaches producing national/international champions. - **Devbhoomi Uttarakhand Lifetime Achievement Award:** Recognizes lifetime contribution to state sports. - **Mukhyamantri Udyan Khiladi Unnayan Yojana:** Monthly sports stipend of **₹1,500** awarded to budding athletes aged 8 to 14 years across all 13 districts.

6. Complete Chronology of Recent Padma Awardees from Uttarakhand

Year	Awardee Name	Award Category	Field of Recognition & High-Yield Prelims Detail
2025	**Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Disciple of Sarla Behn; associated with **Lakshmi Ashram (Kausani)**; championed hill women empowerment and Gandhian rural self-reliance. (UKPCS 2025 Q53)
2024	**Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch**	**Padma Shri**	**Literature & Education:** Renowned historian and archaeologist; author of *Uttarakhand ka Navin Itihas*; founder of 'Himalayan Puratatva Evam Darshan Parishad'.
2022	**General Bipin Rawat** *(Posthumous)*	**Padma Vibhushan**	**Civil Service / Defence:** 1st Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India; native of Saina village, Pauri Garhwal; died in tragic helicopter crash in Coonoor (Tamil Nadu).
2022	**Dr. Madhuri Barthwal**	**Padma Shri**	**Art (Folk Music):** 1st female music composer at All India Radio (Nazibabad); resurrected rare Garhwali folk instruments and songs.
2022	**Smt. Basanti Devi**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Led the successful women-driven civil campaign to save and revive the drying **Kosi River** in Kumaon.
2022	**Vandana Katariya**	**Padma Shri**	**Sports (Hockey):** Haridwar-born hockey forward; 1st Indian woman to score a hat-trick in Olympic hockey (Tokyo 2020).

Year	Awardee Name	Award Category	Field of Recognition & High-Yield Prelims Detail
2021	**Dr. B. K. S. Sanjay**	**Padma Shri**	**Medicine (Orthopaedics):** Renowned Dehradun surgeon; entered Guinness Book for polio corrective surgeries.
2021	**Prem Chand Sharma**	**Padma Shri**	**Agriculture:** Pomegranate, apple, and scientific nursery pioneer from Chakrata (Jaunsar).
2020	**Dr. Yogi Aeron**	**Padma Shri**	**Medicine:** Plastic surgeon providing free burn treatment and facial reconstruction to poor hill patients in Dehradun.
2020	**Kalyan Singh Rawat**	**Padma Shri**	**Social Work:** Founder of the eco-cultural **Maiti Movement** (1994) in Gwaldam (Chamoli).

7. Key Environmental, Ecological & Wildlife Current Affairs

- **First Village Declaration:** In April 2023, the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) erected signboards formally designating **Mana Village (Chamoli)** near Badrinath as **"India's First Village"** under the **Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP)**, reversing the colonial concept of the "last Indian village".
- **Asan Conservation Reserve (Ramsar Site):** Situated at the confluence of the Asan and Yamuna rivers in Dehradun. In October 2020, it was declared **Uttarakhand's first Ramsar site** (444 hectares; premier wintering stop for 53 species of trans-Himalayan migratory birds, including the Brahminy duck and bar-headed goose).
- **Pirul Lao–Paise Pao Campaign:** Flagship community forestry campaign launched to tackle devastating summer forest fires (*Vanagni*). Villagers and Van Panchayats collect dry fallen Chir pine needles (*Pirul*) and deposit them at government collection centres at an incentive rate of **₹50 per kilogram**, preventing slope combustion and supplying biomass for clean bio-energy pellets.
- **Project Tiger Golden Jubilee (1973–2023):** Commemorated across Uttarakhand; Corbett National Park maintains the highest tiger density in India (over 260 tigers).
- **First Snow Leopard Conservation Centre:** Established at **Lanka, near Bhaironghati in Uttarkashi district** in collaboration with UNDP under the *SECURE Himalaya* project.
- **Lichen Park (Munsyari):** India's first lichen park developed at **Munsyari (Pithoragarh)** sheltering over 150 species of lichens (*Jhula ghaas*).
- **Cryptogamic Garden (Deoban, Chakrata):** India's first cryptogamic garden at Deoban (2,700 m altitude) housing 76 species of ferns, fungi, algae, and bryophytes.
- **Moss Garden (Khurpatal, Nainital):** India's first dedicated moss garden conservation project.
- **First Pollinator Park:** Established at **Haldwani (Nainital)** across 4 acres conserving 40+ species of butterflies, honeybees, and birds.

8. State Government Welfare Schemes (2023–2026 Master Table)

Scheme Name	Nodal Department	Beneficiary Group & Key Provisions
Mukhyamantri Mahalakshmi Yojana	Women & Child Development	Provides comprehensive postpartum nutrition and hygiene kit containing baby clothes, blankets, sanitizers, and almonds for newborn children and mothers.
Mukhyamantri Anchal Amrit Yojana	Women & Child Development	Distributes 100 ml of free fortified milk twice a week to children aged 3 to 6 years in all Anganwadi centres to eradicate malnourishment and stunting.
Ghasyari Kalyan Yojana	Animal Husbandry & Cooperative	Delivers vacuum-packed nutrient-dense green fodder silage directly to rural hill cattle owners at a subsidized rate of **₹3 per kg**, liberating women from dangerous forest foraging.
Mukhyamantri Saur Swarojgar Yojana	Energy / UREDA	Subsidized installation of 20 to 25 kW small grid-connected solar power plants on degraded terraced lands by unemployed youth and returning hill migrants.
Him Prahari Scheme	Home / Border Welfare	Incentivizes ex-servicemen and young residents to settle permanently in depopulated border villages along the Indo-Tibetan and Nepal borders to prevent demographic vacuum and provide border intelligence.
Apuni Sarkar Portal	Information Technology	Centralized G2C portal hosting over **400 citizen services** with DigiLocker integration and digital certificate delivery.

Scheme Name	Nodal Department	Beneficiary Group & Key Provisions
Chief Minister Helpline 1905	Public Grievances	24x7 toll-free public grievance redressal portal with mandatory time-bound resolution tracking directly reviewed by the CM.
Mukhyamantri Pratibhashali Chhatra Protsahan Yojana	Higher Education	Monthly scholarships awarded to top-ranking meritorious students of government schools and universities.

Confused Pairs & Common Traps

Confused Pair	Critical Distinction
Radha Bahin Bhatt vs Madhuri Barthwal	Radha Bahin Bhatt = **2025 Padma Shri (Social Work, Kausani)**; Madhuri Barthwal = **2022 Padma Shri (Folk Music)**.
Silkyara Tunnel Length	Exactly **4.531 km** (trap options: 3.531 km, 6.531 km).
Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Rail Length	Exactly **125.2 km**; **84% (~105 km) inside tunnels**.
UCC Tribal Applicability	Scheduled Tribes (STs) are **COMPLETELY EXEMPTED** from UCC.
G20 Ramnagar vs Narendra Nagar	Ramnagar = **Science Advisers (CSAR)**; Narendra Nagar = **Anti-Corruption & Infrastructure**.
38th National Games Mascot	**Monal** (State Bird of Uttarakhand).
First Ramsar Site in UK	**Asan Conservation Reserve** (Dehradun, 2020) — NOT Nainital Lake or Corbett.
First Village Designation	**Mana Village (Chamoli)** — designated “First Village”, no longer “Last Village”.

Practice Zone — UKPCS Format

> **15 questions** targeting direct UKPCS Prelims recurring patterns: UCC, Infrastructure, Reservation Acts, Schemes, GI Tags, and State Firsts.

Q1 (UKPCS Prelims 2025, Q53). Who among the following received the Padma Shri Award in 2025 for social work from Uttarakhand?

A. Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch
B. Dr. Madhuri Barthwal
C. Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt
D. Shri Hugh and Colleen Gantzer

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt was awarded the Padma Shri in 2025 for Social Work. She has devoted decades of service to women's education, rural empowerment, and environmental preservation at Lakshmi Ashram (Kausani, Bageshwar), founded by Sarala Behn. **Ans: C.** Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt.

Q2 (UKPCS Prelims 2025, Q51). The Silkyara Tunnel spanning ___ is expected to shorten the distance between Gangotri and Yamunotri by above 20 km.

A. 2.531 km
B. 3.531 km
C. 4.531 km
D. 6.531 km

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The Silkyara–Barkot Bi-directional Tunnel on NH-134 in Uttarkashi has an exact surveyed length of 4.531 km. It gained international renown during Operation Zindagi in November 2023. **Ans: C.** 4.531 km.

Q3. Under the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) of Uttarakhand Act 2024, which section of society is explicitly exempted from its application?

A. Linguistic minorities
B. Non-resident Indians (NRIs)
C. Scheduled Tribes (STs)
D. Farmers with small landholdings

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Section 3(2) of the Uttarakhand UCC Act, 2024 explicitly exempts members of Scheduled Tribes defined under Article 366(25) of the Constitution of India (such as Tharu, Jaunsari, Bhotia, Buksa, Raji). **Ans: C.** Scheduled Tribes (STs).

Q4. Where was the first official G20 meeting in Uttarakhand (Chief Science Advisers' Roundtable - CSAR) hosted in March 2023?

A. Narendra Nagar (Tehri)
B. Ramnagar (Nainital)
C. Dehradun
D. Mussoorie

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The 1st G20 meeting in the state (CSAR) was held at Ramnagar (Jim Corbett National Park gateway, Nainital) on 28–30 March 2023. The other two meetings (Anti-Corruption Working Group in May and Infrastructure Working Group in June) were held at Narendra Nagar (Tehri Garhwal). **Ans: B.** Ramnagar (Nainital).

Q5. In December 2023, Uttarakhand became the first state in India to receive how many Geographical Indication (GI) certificates in a single day?

A. 10
B. 12
C. 15
D. 18

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Uttarakhand made national history by receiving 18 GI certificates in a single day at the Uttarakhand Global Investors Summit 2023, taking its certified indigenous product count to over 27. **Ans: D.** 18.

Q6. The first wetland conservation reserve of Uttarakhand to be declared a Ramsar Site in 2020 is:

A. Jhilmil Jheel
B. Asan Conservation Reserve
C. Nainital Lake
D. Dodital

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Asan Conservation Reserve (Dehradun district, at the confluence of the Asan and Yamuna rivers) was designated as Uttarakhand's first Ramsar site in October 2020. **Ans: B.** Asan Conservation Reserve.

Q7. Under the Uttarakhand Public Services (Horizontal Reservation for Women) Act, what percentage of horizontal reservation is provided to women domiciled in Uttarakhand in state public services?

A. 20%
B. 30%
C. 33%
D. 50%

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The Uttarakhand Legislative Assembly passed the Act providing 30% horizontal reservation in direct recruitment to public services and posts for domicile women of Uttarakhand (effective upon Governor assent on 10 January 2023). **Ans: B.** 30%.

Q8. Under the Uttarakhand Competitive Examination (Measures for Control and Prevention of Unfair Means in Recruitment) Act 2023, what is the maximum punishment for offenders involved in organised paper leaks?

A. 5 years imprisonment and ₹10 Lakh fine
B. 10 years imprisonment and ₹1 Crore fine
C. Imprisonment for life and fine up to ₹10 Crore
D. 7 years imprisonment and property attachment only

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The strict Anti-Cheating Act of 2023 prescribes life imprisonment and a fine of up to ₹10 Crore, along with property confiscation for paper-leak syndicates. Candidates caught cheating face a ban of up to 10 years. **Ans: C.** Imprisonment for life and fine up to ₹10 Crore.

Q9. With reference to the Rishikesh–Karnaprayag Broad Gauge Rail Line project, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The total length of the railway alignment is 125.2 km.
2. Approximately 84% of the rail route passes through 17 tunnels.
3. The longest tunnel on this section connects Devprayag to Janasu (~15.1 km).

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: All three statements are correct engineering facts of the RVNL-executed Rishikesh–Karnaprayag rail link (125.2 km, 17 tunnels covering ~105 km, 12 railway stations). **Ans: D.** 1, 2 and 3.

Q10. The Jamrani Dam Multipurpose Project, included under the PM Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY-AIBP), is being constructed on which river in Nainital district?

A. Kosi River
B. Gola River
C. Ramganga River
D. Gaula/Sharda confluence

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Jamrani Dam is being constructed across the Gola (Gaula) River in Nainital district to supply drinking water to Haldwani and irrigate large tracts in Uttarakhand and Bareilly/Rampur in Uttar Pradesh. **Ans: B.** Gola River.

Q11. Which bird was unveiled as the official mascot for the 38th National Games hosted by Uttarakhand?

A. Monal (Himalayan Monal)
B. Cheer Pheasant
C. Western Tragopan
D. Great Indian Hornbill

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The official mascot for the 38th National Games in Uttarakhand is the Himalayan Monal (*Lophophorus impejanus*), which is also the State Bird of Uttarakhand. **Ans: A.** Monal (Himalayan Monal).

Q12. In April 2023, the Government of India officially repositioned Mana village in Chamoli from being known as the 'Last Village' of India to:

A. The Gateway Village
B. The First Indian Village
C. Border Model Post
D. Sentinel Village

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Under the Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP), BRO and the Central Government officially designated Mana Village (near Badrinath in Chamoli) as the 'First Indian Village' instead of the earlier colonial reference of 'Last Village'. **Ans: B.** The First Indian Village.

Q13. Under Uttarakhand's 'Pirul Lao–Paise Pao' environmental initiative launched to prevent devastating forest fires, what financial incentive is paid per kilogram of collected dry pine needles (Pirul)?

A. ₹10 per kg
B. ₹25 per kg
C. ₹50 per kg
D. ₹100 per kg

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: The State Government fixed a rate of ₹50 per kg for pine needles (Pirul) collected by villagers and Van Panchayats, which is processed into bio-fuel and pellets, drastically mitigating forest fire hazards. **Ans: C.** ₹50 per kg.

Q14. Where was India's first Snow Leopard Conservation Centre established in Uttarakhand in collaboration with UNDP?

A. Munsyari, Pithoragarh
B. Lanka / Bhaironghati, Uttarkashi
C. Dhak, Chamoli
D. Kedarnath Wildlife Division, Rudraprayag

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: India's first Snow Leopard Conservation Centre was set up at Lanka near Bhaironghati in the Uttarkashi district under the SECURE Himalaya project. **Ans: B.** Lanka / Bhaironghati, Uttarkashi.

Q15. Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch, honoured with the Padma Shri in 2024 from Uttarakhand, is an eminent scholar in which domain?

A. Traditional Folk Architecture and Wooden Carving
B. Himalayan Archaeology, History and Literature
C. High-Altitude Herbal Medicine
D. Environmental Law and River Ecosystems

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch is one of the premier historians and archaeologists of the Central Himalayas, author of monumental works such as *Madhya Himalaya ka Puratattva*. **Ans: B.** Himalayan Archaeology, History and Literature.